California - home Insurance - Guidelines

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Purpose and authority

Internal Home insurance operating guidelines for California (CA). Apply only within delegated underwriting and claims authority. These standards do not create coverage, replace policy wording, or establish government requirements.

Application and eligibility

Record occupancy, construction, year built, roof condition, replacement-cost estimate, protection systems, maintenance, prior losses, and mortgage interests. Refer vacant, short-term rental, major renovation, unusual construction, and high-value property exposures.

Coverage design

Review dwelling, other structures, personal property, loss of use, personal liability, and medical payments against the proposed form. Discuss valuation, deductibles, sublimits, exclusions, and optional endorsements. Assess flood and earthquake needs separately; never imply they are included without checking the contract.

Inspection and mitigation

Obtain address-level hazard evidence and inspection consent as appropriate. Record roof, electrical, plumbing, heating, water-leak, defensible-space, and security findings. Use risk-specific evidence, not a state code alone, to request mitigation or refer the risk.

Claims handling

Record cause, date, damaged property, emergency mitigation, occupancy impact, photographs, inventory, and estimates. Assess additional living expense only under the issued terms. Escalate disputed causation, catastrophe losses, litigation, and coverage interpretation.

State risk review

For California (CA), screen for address-level flood, severe weather, fire, theft, liability, and service interruption exposure; wildland interface, smoke, evacuation access, and vegetation management where relevant. These are internal screening priorities, not a finding that a particular location has the exposure. Validate the individual risk with current evidence.

Decision record and quality control

Record the CA jurisdiction, product, form version, evidence, coverage discussion, referral decision, approver, and communication history. Require a second review for authority exceptions. Keep internal business rules separate from legally required rules and retain the evidence under the approved retention schedule.